

Beaconhouse National University



Assignment: Reading 7.1

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Department: SCIT (BSCS)

Course: Functional English

Submitted by: Saad Mughal

Submitted to: Miss Naureen Zaman

Student ID: F2023-009

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POLLUTION IN LAHORE

Lahore is one of the top 10 places in the world where the amount of pollution is a health hazard. Lahore regularly ranks at the top of IQAir AirVisual's live pollution rankings of major global cities. Study shows that living in Lahore decreases life span by 7 years.

However, pollution only rose to the top of the public's consciousness in early 2017, when actionable air quality data was published for the first time in Pakistan. Because there was no data from the government, citizens used their own equipment to monitor fine particulate matter, also known as PM2.5, and report data in realtime. The data exposed Lahore's high levels of air pollution which eventually became a media's talking point and shocked the public.

As of November 2019, Pakistani authorities still don't publish any real-time PM2.5 air quality data. All data comes from non-government sensors and the U.S state department. The US embassy in Islamabad, and the three US Consulates in Karachi, Lahore and Peshawar began monitoring and publishing real-time PM2.5 data online in the first half of 2019.

The reason for such high quality pollution is due to farmers burning their remaining crops during winter from Oct-Feb, this produces smoke that adds to smog. At the same time, weather changes mean pollutants remain trapped in the air for longer.

Other reasons include a combination of vehicle and industrial emissions, smoke from brick kilns, general waste, and dust from construction sites.

Winter air pollution is worse due to temperature inversion, which results in a layer of warm air that is prevented from rising trapping air pollutants.

There are several ways to reduce pollution in Lahore, the first step is to make real-time air quality data available to everyone with greater granularity. When people know how much pollution they are breathing, they'll start taking measures to protect themselves.

Another way is to reduce industrial and vehicle emissions by using public transportation like metro bus, and orange train. If everyone brings out their own transportation then it not only becomes crowded but pollution increases exponentially.

My Views

The best method in my opinion to reduce pollution from vehicles is using electric cars/bikes. But in my research it showed that petrol companies like PSO, CALTEX etc pay the Pakistani government to not bring electric cars in Pakistan because that could ruin their business. Electric cars are generally cheaper in cost and environment friendly as they don't make any sounds nor any waste smoke.

My Questions

Why doesn't the government take any action against farmers who burn their crops?

Sources

<https://www.igair.com/pakistan/punjab/lahore>